

CPF Housing Grants Guide

Understanding CPF Grants for Resale and BTO Public Housing in Singapore

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Important: This guide is a practice document produced for training purposes. Grant amounts, income ceilings, and eligibility criteria are subject to change. Always verify the latest information at www.cpf.gov.sg or via the CPF website.

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1. Introduction to CPF Housing Grants

The CPF Board administers a range of housing grants to help eligible Singaporeans with the purchase of their first HDB flat. These grants are credited directly into the buyer's CPF Ordinary Account (OA) and can be used to offset the purchase price or reduce the housing loan amount.

The primary grants available as of 2025 are the Enhanced CPF Housing Grant (EHG), the Family Grant, the Half-Housing Grant, the Proximity Housing Grant (PHG), and the Step-Up CPF Housing Grant. These grants may be stacked (combined) subject to eligibility conditions.

Key Principle: CPF Housing Grants are disbursed into the CPF OA — they are NOT cash payouts. The grant amount reduces the amount of cash or mortgage needed to finance the flat purchase.

2. Enhanced CPF Housing Grant (EHG)

The Enhanced CPF Housing Grant (EHG) is the largest and most significant grant available to first-timer applicants. It was introduced in September 2019, replacing the Additional CPF Housing Grant (AHG) and Special CPF Housing Grant (SHG).

2.1 EHG — Eligibility Criteria

- At least one buyer must be a Singapore Citizen.
- All applicants must be first-timers (never received an HDB flat or CPF Housing Grant before).
- Applicants must have been continuously employed for 12 months prior to application.
- Gross monthly household income must not exceed S\$9,000.
- For singles applying under the Single SC Scheme: gross monthly income ≤ S\$4,500.
- The flat's remaining lease must be at least 20 years, and must cover the youngest applicant to at least age 95.

2.2 EHG Grant Amounts — Families and Couples

Average Monthly Household Income	Grant Amount (BTO)	Grant Amount (Resale)
S\$1,500 and below	S\$80,000	S\$80,000
S\$1,501 – S\$2,000	S\$75,000	S\$75,000
S\$2,001 – S\$2,500	S\$70,000	S\$70,000
S\$2,501 – S\$3,000	S\$65,000	S\$65,000
S\$3,001 – S\$3,500	S\$60,000	S\$60,000
S\$3,501 – S\$4,000	S\$55,000	S\$55,000
S\$4,001 – S\$4,500	S\$50,000	S\$50,000
S\$4,501 – S\$5,000	S\$45,000	S\$45,000

Average Monthly Household Income	Grant Amount (BTO)	Grant Amount (Resale)
S\$5,001 – S\$5,500	S\$40,000	S\$40,000
S\$5,501 – S\$6,000	S\$35,000	S\$35,000
S\$6,001 – S\$6,500	S\$30,000	S\$30,000
S\$6,501 – S\$7,000	S\$25,000	S\$25,000
S\$7,001 – S\$7,500	S\$20,000	S\$20,000
S\$7,501 – S\$8,000	S\$15,000	S\$15,000
S\$8,001 – S\$8,500	S\$10,000	S\$10,000
S\$8,501 – S\$9,000	S\$5,000	S\$5,000
Above S\$9,000	Not eligible	Not eligible

2.3 EHG for Singles (Single SC Scheme)

Singles applying for a 2-room Flexi flat under the Single SC Scheme are eligible for half the family EHG amount, subject to a maximum monthly income of S\$4,500.

3. Family Grant for Resale Flats

The Family Grant (previously known as the Additional CPF Housing Grant before 2019 reforms) is available to first-timer families and couples purchasing a resale flat.

3.1 Eligibility

- SC/SC couple or family: at least one applicant is an SC.
- SC/SPR couple or family: at least one applicant is an SC and the other is an SPR.
- All applicants must be first-timers.
- Gross monthly household income $\leq$ S\$14,000.
- Buying a resale flat (not a BTO or SBF flat).

3.2 Grant Amounts

Flat Type	SC/SC Household	SC/SPR Household
2-room resale flat	S\$50,000	S\$40,000
3-room resale flat	S\$50,000	S\$40,000
4-room resale flat	S\$50,000	S\$40,000
5-room or larger resale flat	S\$40,000	S\$30,000

4. Half-Housing Grant

The Half-Housing Grant applies where one applicant is a first-timer and the other is a second-timer (has previously received an HDB flat or housing subsidy).

Flat Type	Grant Amount
2-room or 3-room resale flat	S\$25,000
4-room resale flat	S\$25,000
5-room or larger resale flat	S\$20,000

The Half-Housing Grant is half the Family Grant amount. The second-timer applicant is also subject to a resale levy if they previously received an HDB housing subsidy.

5. Proximity Housing Grant (PHG)

The Proximity Housing Grant (PHG) encourages multi-generational families to live near one another. It is available exclusively for resale flat purchases.

5.1 PHG Amounts

Living Arrangement	Grant for Family/Couple	Grant for Singles
Living with parents / married child	S\$30,000	S\$15,000
Living near parents / married child (within 4 km)	S\$20,000	S\$10,000

5.2 PHG Eligibility Conditions

- Gross monthly household income $\leq$ S\$14,000.
- At least one applicant must be an SC.
- Applicants must be first-timers (one exception: second-timers may also qualify for PHG if the other eligibility conditions are met, but subject to income ceiling and other rules).
- 'Living with' means the parents/married child are listed as occupiers in the same flat.
- 'Living near' means the parents/married child reside in a flat within 4 km by road distance.
- The proximity condition must be maintained for at least 5 years after purchase.

6. Step-Up CPF Housing Grant

The Step-Up CPF Housing Grant of **S\$15,000** is available to second-timer families who previously bought a 2-room subsidised flat from HDB and are now looking to upgrade to a 3-room flat in a non-mature estate.

- Buyer must be a second-timer couple or family (previously owned a 2-room BTO flat).

- Upgrading to a 3-room flat in a non-mature estate only.
- Income ceiling: S\$7,000 gross household income per month.
- Must have completed the MOP for the previous 2-room flat.

7. Grant Stacking — Combining Multiple Grants

Eligible buyers can combine multiple grants, subject to all individual grant eligibility conditions being met. Below are common stacking combinations for resale purchases:

Buyer Profile	Grants Stackable	Maximum Combined Grant
SC/SC first-timer couple, income S\$4,000, 4-room resale near parents	EHG + Family Grant + PHG	S\$55,000 + S\$50,000 + S\$20,000 = S\$125,000
SC/SPR first-timer couple, income S\$7,000, 4-room resale	EHG + Family Grant	S\$25,000 + S\$40,000 = S\$65,000
SC first-timer with SC/SPR second-timer spouse, income S\$6,000, 4-room resale	Half-Housing Grant + PHG (if proximity)	S\$25,000 + S\$20,000 = S\$45,000
SC/SC first-timer couple, income S\$10,000, 4-room resale, living with parents	Family Grant + PHG only (EHG income ceiling exceeded)	S\$50,000 + S\$30,000 = S\$80,000

8. Using Grant Funds — Rules and Restrictions

CPF Housing Grants are credited into the buyer's CPF Ordinary Account and are subject to the following rules:

Rule	Details
Credited to CPF OA only	Grant monies are deposited into CPF OA. Buyers cannot receive cash.
Immediate offset of purchase price	The grant reduces the amount you need to pay from your CPF OA savings or cash.
Accrued interest	CPF grants are treated as CPF OA withdrawals. Accrued interest at the OA rate (currently 2.5% p.a.) must be returned to CPF upon sale of the flat.
Cannot be used for renovation	Grant funds cannot be used for renovation, furnishings, or any purpose other than the flat purchase.
No CPF grant top-up for shortfalls	If grant is insufficient, buyers must top up with cash or additional CPF OA savings.

Rule	Details
Grant reclaim upon ineligibility	If eligibility conditions are subsequently found not to have been met, CPF Board may reclaim the grant amount plus accrued interest.

9. Application Process

Step 1: Register Intent to Buy (ITB) on HDB Flat Portal

When you register your ITB at flatportal.hdb.gov.sg, HDB automatically checks your eligibility for CPF Housing Grants based on the information you provide. Eligible grants are shown in your dashboard.

Step 2: Apply for HLE Letter (if using HDB loan)

The HLE application factors in any CPF grants to compute your net loan quantum. This helps you determine your monthly instalment.

Step 3: Submit Resale Application Together with Sellers

Both buyer and seller submit their respective portions of the resale application via HDB Flat Portal. Grant details are included in the buyer's application.

Step 4: CPF Board Processes Grant

After HDB's resale approval, CPF Board processes the grant and credits it to your CPF OA. The grant amount is then used to offset the flat purchase price or reduce your outstanding loan.

Step 5: Completion

On the completion date, all grant proceeds are applied. The balance (if any) must be covered by cash or CPF OA savings by the buyer.

10. Grant Comparison Summary Table

Grant	Max Amount (Family)	Income Ceiling	Flat Type
Enhanced CPF Housing Grant (EHG)	S\$80,000	S\$9,000/mth	BTO or Resale
Family Grant	S\$50,000 (SC/SC) S\$40,000 (SC/SPR)	S\$14,000/mth	Resale only
Half-Housing Grant	S\$25,000	S\$14,000/mth	Resale only
Proximity Housing Grant — with parents	S\$30,000	S\$14,000/mth	Resale only
Proximity Housing Grant — near parents	S\$20,000	S\$14,000/mth	Resale only
Step-Up CPF Housing Grant	S\$15,000	S\$7,000/mth	3-room resale (non-mature)

11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I use CPF Housing Grant proceeds to pay for renovation?

A: No. CPF Housing Grants are credited into your CPF OA and used strictly to offset the flat purchase price or reduce your housing loan. They cannot be withdrawn as cash for renovation or other purposes.

Q: What happens to the grant if I sell the flat?

A: Upon sale, you must refund the CPF grant amount (plus accrued interest at CPF OA rate) back into your CPF OA. The refund forms part of your CPF retirement savings.

Q: Can I apply for CPF Housing Grant if I am self-employed?

A: Yes. Self-employed persons may qualify for the EHG if they have contributed to Medisave for the preceding 12 months, which is used as a proxy for continuous employment.

Q: Does the grant affect my HDB loan quantum?

A: Yes. If you use an HDB loan, the loan quantum is calculated on the purchase price minus grants. A higher grant reduces the loan amount and monthly instalments.

Q: Can PRs apply for CPF Housing Grants?

A: SPRs alone are not eligible for CPF Housing Grants. However, an SC/SPR couple where at least one applicant is an SC may qualify for the Family Grant and PHG.

Q: What is the difference between the EHG and the old AHG/SHG grants?

A: The EHG replaced both the Additional CPF Housing Grant (AHG) and the Special CPF Housing Grant (SHG) from September 2019 onwards. The EHG has a higher maximum (S\$80,000 vs. S\$40,000 AHG max) and applies equally to BTO and resale flats.

Disclaimer: This document is a practice/training resource only. Grant amounts, eligibility criteria and income ceilings are subject to change by CPF Board and HDB. For official and current information, visit www.cpf.gov.sg/housing or call CPF Board's hotline at 1800-227-1188.